

· OpenClaw Course · Module 5 · Integrations · Web Search

1

WHAT THE AGENT ALREADY DOES FOR FREE (WITHOUT CONFIGURING ANYTHING)

· Good news: your agent already knows how to browse the internet.

As soon as you install OpenClaw, two search tools are already available · without configuration, without API key, without extra cost. These are the first things your agent will use when you ask it to search for something.

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FREE · NATIVE

web_search

Web search via integrated Brave. Returns titles, URLs and snippets of the most relevant pages

.

FREE · NATIVE

web_fetch

Reads the complete content of any URL · article, product page, landing page,

· OPENCLAW COURSE

· MODULE 5 · INTEGRATIONS

· NATIVE + ADVANCED

Your agent

browsing the internet

Native Web Search, Brave Search API and Perplexity · from the basics that already work today to in-depth research with AI. Your agent researching the world for you.

Free

TO GET STARTED

2,000

SEARCHES/MONTH FREE

\$0.005

PER PERPLEXITY SEARCH

4

REAL USE CASES

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for a query.

- Real-time search
- Filter by date, language, and region
- No API key required

documentation. Extracts the clean text.

- Any accessible URL
- HTML · readable text
- Works with markdown
- How it looks in practice · examples you can use today:

RESEARCH COMPETITOR

"Research what company X is doing, what their latest posts are, and give me a summary."

- Agent uses web_search + web_fetch on the found pages

CHECK PRODUCT PRICE

"What is the current price of the Pro plan of [tool]? Access their website and tell me."

- Agent accesses the URL directly with web_fetch

READ ARTICLE / DOCUMENTATION

"Read this article for me and tell me the 3 most important points: [paste the URL]"

- web_fetch extracts the content and the agent synthesizes

.

It works without configuring anything

These two commands run on the OpenClaw basic plan. The difference when you configure your own Brave API and Perplexity is volume and depth · but the basics already solve 80% of the cases.

2

LEVELING UP: OWN BRAVE SEARCH API

- Why use your own Brave API key?

The native OpenClaw search is shared · it works, but it has limits. With your own key, you have more results per search, without artificial filters, and total control over volume.

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NATIVE SEARCH VS OWN BRAVE API

FUNCTIONALITY

NATIVE

OWN API

Results per search

Basic

Up to 20 results

Search volume

Shared

2,000/month free

Advanced filters

Limited

Complete

Control by date

Partial

Total

Cost

Free

Free (2k/month)

· How to configure · 3 simple steps:

1

Create your account and get the API key

Go to brave.com/search/api · create an account · go to "API Keys" · click "New Key". The free plan gives 2,000 searches/month · enough for most founders.

2

Configure in OpenClaw

With the key in hand, run the command below in your terminal:

Configure your Brave API Key in OpenClaw

```
openclaw config set brave.apiKey BSA-xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx
```

To confirm it was saved:

```
openclaw config get brave.apiKey
```

3

Done · your agent already uses the new key

From now on, every time the agent uses `web_search`, it will hit your own quota. You can monitor consumption directly on the Brave panel.

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2,000 searches/month · what does this mean in practice?

If your agent does 3-5 searches per day (competitor monitoring, news, etc.), you'll be well within the free limit. For more intensive

3

DEEP RESEARCH: PERPLEXITY API

· What's the difference between web_search and Perplexity?

The web_search gives you links and snippets. Perplexity gives you analysis. It's an AI model that has already read the pages, c

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web_search · use when:

You want to find a specific URL

Monitor if there's any new information

Quick reference search

Check price / company contact information

.

Perplexity · use when:

You want to understand a market

In-depth context research

Analysis of multiple sources

You want a conclusion, not a list of links

· How to set up Perplexity:

1

Create an account and generate the API key

Go to perplexity.ai · Settings · API · "Generate". Perplexity uses prepaid credits · you load \$5, \$10 or more and spend as you us

2

Save in 1Password

Don't save the key directly in the config. Save it in 1Password with the name "Perplexity API" · your agent searches from there v

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Save to 1Password (via op CLI)

op item create \

--category "API Credential" \

--title "Perplexity API" \

--vault "Amora Vault" \

"credential=pplx-xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx"

To search later (the agent does this automatically):

op item get "Perplexity API" --field credential --reveal

3

Ready · call via skill

The Perplexity skill in your workspace already knows how to retrieve the key from 1Password. Just say "use Perplexity to search for X" or configure deep research (see the bonus below).

· HOW MUCH DOES IT COST IN PRACTICE?

\$0.005

PER SEARCH / QUERY

With \$5 of credit you have 1,000 searches. If the agent runs deep research per week (5-8 queries), you spend less than \$2/month. It's too cheap to not use.

·

Ideal combination for serious research

Use web_search for quick scanning (finding the right sources) + Perplexity for in-depth analysis of these sources. This is exactly what the Deep Research protocol in the bonus block does · automatically.

4

REAL USE CASES FOR MICRO-SAAS FOUNDERS

You can do everything below today, with the tools you have already configured. Just tell the agent.

USE CASE #1

USE CASE #2

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Tip: combine with crons for automatic monitoring

The use cases become even more powerful when automated. Configure the agent to run these checks every Monday, every morning, or whenever you need · without having to remember to ask.

· · Monitor competitors

"Every Monday morning, do a search about what [Competitor X] and [Competitor Y] published this week · posts, releases, website changes · and send me a summary on Telegram."

You schedule it via cron in OpenClaw. The agent runs `web_search` automatically, reads the most relevant pages with `web_fetch` and sends you the report.

· Market research

"Analyze the WhatsApp automation tool market in Brazil · main players, price ranges, features that are repeated, opportunities."

Perplexity + `web_fetch` on the pages of competitors. The agent returns with a structured report that would take hours to do manually.

USE CASE #3

· Follow industry news

"Notify me when important news comes out about [topic · e.g. AI regulation in Brazil, changes to the WhatsApp API]."

Daily heartbeat with `web_search` filtering by date. Only notifies you if there is something new · without spam.

USE CASE #4

· · Extract data from websites

"Get the plan prices of the 5 main competitors and put together a table comparative for me."

`web_fetch` on each pricing page. The agent extracts and organizes the data. It works with prices, reviews, contact information · any public data.

· EXCLUSIVE BONUS

Deep Research Skill

This skill transforms your agent into a senior researcher. One instruction transforms `web_search` + `web_fetch` + Perplexity into a complete deep research flow · with actionable report at the end. Paste it directly into your agent.

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Scan (Brave)
General mapping
of the topic with
web_search · finds
the right sources.

.
Deep reading
web_fetch on the
most relevant
pages · extracts
the complete
content.

.
AI analysis
Perplexity cross-references the
information and
delivers synthesis with
conclusion.

name: deep-research-protocol
description: >
Use when asking: "research about", "deep research", "investigates",
"analyzes the market of", "benchmark", "I want to understand better",
"competitor analysis", "give me an overview of".

Deep Research Protocol
Protocol (execute in order)
1. FRAMING (2 min)
- What is the exact question I am answering?
- What decision will this research inform?
- Depth: quick scan (5-10 min) | standard (15-30 min) | deep dive
2. MULTI-SOURCE COLLECTION
Primary sources (in this order):
1. web_search · general scan (Brave)
2. web_fetch · extract content from the most relevant URLs
3. Perplexity API · synthesis with AI and citations (key in 1Password: "Perple
4. Knowledge Base · if there is relevant content already ingested
Specialized sources (when relevant):
- Reddit/HackerNews · opinion of the technical community
- Twitter/X · real-time signals
- YouTube · long analyses
3. SYNTHESIS
For each source, classify:
- FACT · confirmable, with source
- OPINION · interpretation, mark as such
- SIGNAL · suggests trend, monitor

SKILL.MD

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4. REPORT (standard format)

[Topic] · Deep Research

Date: DD/MM/YYYY

TL;DR

- [3-5 bullets with the essentials]

Context

[Why we are researching / what decision this informs]

Findings

[Subtopic 1]

- Finding + source

[Subtopic 2]

- Finding + source

Analysis

[Crossing of findings, patterns, what it means]

Recommendation

[What to do with this information]

Sources

1. [URL 1]

2. [URL 2]

5. SAVING

- Save to memory/research-YYYY-MM-DD-[slug].md

Depth Levels

| Quick scan | 5-10 min | 3-5 URLs | 1 paragraph + bullets |

| Standard | 15-30 min | 8-12 URLs | 1-2 page report |

| Deep dive | 30-60 min | 15-20 URLs | 3-5 page report |

Biases to avoid

- Confirmation bias · actively seek counter-arguments

- Recency bias · check if trends are real or hype

- Survivorship bias · look for cases of failure, not just success

Prompts that activate this skill

"Deep research: automation tools for WhatsApp in Brazil"

"Analyze the online AI course market in 2026"

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Lesson: Your agent navigating the internet · Web Search + Brave API + Perplexity

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HOW THE FLOW WORKS:

· Your question

·

· web_search

·

· web_fetch

·

· Perplexity

·

· Report

·

How to install this skill on your agent

Save the content above in a file skills/research/deep-research-protocol/SKILL.md inside your agent's workspace. From there, when you say

"do a deep research", it will follow the protocol automatically.

"Research the 5 largest competitors of [product]: features, prices, diffe

"Investigate why [company X] grew so fast"

"Benchmark: how do the best SaaS in [category] do onboarding?"

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